

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 2

--"MINI-MEETNG" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of upcoming KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Now let's look at John's first letter, toward the back of the New Testament. This is Nancy's translation of **1 John 4:16–19**.

¹⁶We have come to know and have trusted the love which God has in us. God is love, and the one who dwells in love dwells in God, and God dwells in that one. ¹⁷By this, love is perfected with us, so that we may have boldness in the day of judgment, because as He is, so also are we in this world. ¹⁸There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts out fear, because fear involves punishment or torment, and the one who fears is not perfected in love. ¹⁹We love because He first extended love to us.

Take a deep breath.

1. **Agape love, when oriented, is God's love expressed through our lives**

Our poor Idol Self cannot love others or God because it is constantly reacting to outside threats and fiercely defending its ego, its stories, and its pride. Oriented agape love is responsive not reactive; it is not swayed by circumstances, nor is it determined by the merits of the one who is loved. This love is generated within the redeemed True Self through its correspondence, or co-responding, with God. It only exists in our world because someone has done the hard work that is necessary to become the love of God on earth. So, this love is really about your character and your connection to God. We have been created in God's image; therefore, each one of us is uniquely designed to express His love. When you express God's love through who you are and how you live, you display to the world both your Creator's glory and your own.

2. **The meaning of perfect**

Now that we are looking closely at these verses in First John, it is important to clarify the meaning of the word *perfect*, which is repeated several times in this passage. When we read the word perfect in English versions of the New Testament, we get the feeling that nothing is valuable unless it meets a certain standard. We must act perfectly, look perfect, think perfect thoughts, and, in this case, love perfectly—or else all of our efforts have no value. If we think this way, anything less than perfect love is judged as

worthless. There is no invitation for more growth or training. If you have been raised this way, you know how painful and destructive that is.

However, these idealized standards of perfection are not what John is talking about. The word perfect is a translation of the Greek word *telos*, meaning the fulfillment of an intention or design. We could also translate *telos* using words like mature, accomplished, fulfilled, or fully developed. When John talks about a perfect love, he is referring to a love that is fully developed; it is fulfilling its purpose, and that purpose is to cast out fear. When your love starts casting out fear, you will know that your love is perfect—it is doing its job.

3. People of no fear

In verse 18 we read, “There is no fear in love; but developed love casts out fear, because fear involves punishment or torment, and the one who fears is not fully developed in love.” Our tendency is to focus on fighting our fears in order to avoid the torment, but John and God would have us focus on growing our love. As your love grows, your fears will automatically lose their power, and you will experience more freedom. Your goal is not to get rid of your fears; your goal is to grow your love.

4. Learn to spot the fear

When you are punishing yourself, or punishing someone else, know that fear is motivating you. You are afraid of losing the life that you imagine will keep you safe and happy. When you feel the self-hate of the Idol whipping you from within, stop and think: *Fear is not my friend. Love is the foundation from which I will deal with self-hate.* Have that discussion with yourself and then tell your Idol Self to back off.

So, think about this: Your Idol Self is motivated by fear, your True Self is motivated by love, and you are learning to recognize the difference.

You can take this week’s Bible passage from First John and turn it into a prayer. In fact, let’s do that right now.
(Pause)

Lord, lead me to know and trust Your love. Teach me how to dwell in Your love. Mature Your love in me that I may be a person of no fear. (Repeat the last sentence)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are very grateful for this time together. Hold us in the patterns of this new understanding as You guide us to our glory and to the truth. Lead us to the next step in our healing this week and reorient our lives to a more effective flow, to furthering our connection with ourselves, with our community, with the Creation, and with You, for the honor and the glory of our Lord Jesus. Amen.